



Makahiki

Makahiki is a harvest festival that lasts four lunar months from roughly October/ November until February/ March. It is a celebration of the bounty of the land during which many festivities and religious rites take place. In ancient times, the common folk would take a break from their labors to practice arts and recreation. Warfare was prohibited during this time.

The festival is still celebrated in some places, though usually in a watered-down form.



fertility deities. War is a more violent aspect, associated with Ku, the god of all aspects of warfare.

As with the Court structure, Menehune can shift between the two camps and often do. Unlike the Nunnehi, they do not have a transitional Camp. Most Menehune maintain the Feast Camp during the four months of the Makahiki.

Legacy

Menehune have dual Legacies in the same fashion as all other changelings — one to reflect his Feast nature and one to reflect his War nature. Use the Legacies described in the Nunnehi section for Menehune, Summer Legacies for Feast and Winter for War.

Calling

In a sense, Menehune are all one kith. For the most part, they have similar appearances, their clothing and adornments being the easiest way to tell them apart. Menehune follow a very strict social division to which they are born. A Menehune cannot choose her calling, since it is considered to be divinely ordained and unchangeable. Most Menehune simply accept this, and as a result they have not suffered the societal upheaval that has created the schism between the nobles and commoners of Western fae.

The nobles of Menehune society are the ali'i and the kahuna, while the hana and kokua are the commoners.

Ali'i

The ali'i share much in common with the sidhe. They are natural leaders, though unlike the sidhe, they rarely allow it to go to their heads. The ali'i are all descendant from one of the royal bloodlines that once produced the Menehune kings.

In ages past, every village had a chief. In modern times, there is only one chief, so all ali'i act as subchiefs to the head chief. In recent years, fewer and fewer ali'i have been born. Unlike the sidhe, the ali'i became changelings in the same manner as the commoners, so the decrease is quite a mystery. Subchiefs are expected to advise the high chief and serve as examples to the common folk. They tend to keep separate from the com-

moners, but this is more to reinforce their magical purity rather than from a sense of self-importance or disdain.

The ali'i are the bearers of the Menehune's Mana. They take the place of the balefire in Kithain society and store Mana for times of great need.

The ali'i resemble the sidhe in that they are the beautiful people of the Menehune. Their skin is flawless and golden or deep mahogany brown. Their hair is dark, thick and lustrous and their teeth gleam brightly when they smile their wide and welcoming smiles.

Affinity: Fae

Birthrights

Unearthly Beauty — As the Arcadian sidhe Birthright (p. 107).

Glamour Vessel — Ali'i can hold quadruple their Mana rating in a reservoir of temporary points. (An ali'i with a Mana of six has an additional 24 points in this reservoir.) These points can only be invested into the ali'i by other Menehune, and only during the annual Malahiki feast. Menehune participating in the feast can spend Mana and invest it into the a chosen ali'i, who stores it for later use. The ali'i cannot use the stored Mana himself, rather it can be drawn by other Menehune to fuel their cantrips or for any other use. Use of the stored Mana is not limited to those who invested Mana, and can be used by any Menehune. The ali'i must grant permission and the Menehune must be within 50 feet.

Frailties

Sacrosanct — Without a balefire to enliven their freeholds, it falls to an ali'i and his stored Mana to get the Menehune through difficult times. This is a sacred trust and quite fragile. If Banality ever touches the ali'i, much of his stored Mana is destroyed (five points of stored temporary Mana is destroyed for every point of temporary Banality gained).

Stepping on an ali'i's shadow is taboo. Every time this taboo is broken the ali'i loses one point of temporary Mana (stored Mana first and then his own). Also, whenever the ali'i who leads the village walks past a commoner, his retinue blow conch horns. Any commoner who does not bow before the ali'i causes him to lose a point of temporary Mana. For ali'i who are not the village leader, commoners are not required to bow and must only acknowledge the presence of the ali'i in some formal manner — a nod or formal greeting suffices. Also, this taboo does not apply to non-Menehune, although the taboo against stepping on the ali'i's shadow does.

"You dare come before me like this? You are from far lands and have strange ways, but this does not excuse your rudeness. Bow now, then we will talk."

Kahuna

The kahunas are the intermediaries between the spirits and the Menehune. They are the lorekeepers mystics, and temple builders. They commune with the spirits to determine

